L3 - Info

NAME .....

SURNAME .....

IDENTITY CARD NUMBER .....

LEVEL .....

PART 1/Reading Comprehension:

I/Read through the article and say whether these sentences are true or false

1-Michael Porter started working on strategy in the 1990s. .....

2-The forces operate differently in each industry. .....

3-With the value chain, companies can only become more competitive in one way. .....

4-The value chain is very important for a company in analysing the competition. .....

5-Porter's theories can be applied to economies. .....

II/Find in the article words or expressions that have the same meaning as the following:

1-an attitude to a particular issue(p2) .....

2-applied(p2) .....

3-extremely important(p6).....

4-shows (p6).....

5-the total(p6) .....

III/What is the key message of the article? Choose the best alternative. The article looks mainly at Porter's .....

1-consulting work for governments on national economies.

2-teaching in the 1990s

3-work on the five competitive forces and the value chain.

IV/Answer this question according to your own knowledge. Does competition always improve the performance of companies?Why/Why not?

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The master strategist

1-Michael Porter became famous in the 1990s as a consultant on competitiveness to business and governments. In the 1980s, however, he wrote several popular and respected books on business strategy, introducing basic tools of strategic thinking such as the 'five forces' model and the value chain. It is for this work on strategy that he is likely to be remembered, and his ideas have had a wide impact. In 1999, Fortune called him the single most important strategist working today, and possibly of all time.

2-Prof Porter views strategy from the standpoint of economics, and his ideas on how strategy should be implemented are based on an understanding of competition and other economic forces. Strategy is not devised in isolation: a company's options will always be limited by what is going on around it.

3-His famous 'five forces' model shows the constraining impact that competition and environment have on strategy.

The five forces identified by Prof Porter are:

A) the threat of new entrants and the appearance of new competitors;

B) The degree of rivalry among existing competitors in the market;

C) The bargaining power of buyers;

D) The bargaining power of suppliers;

E) The threat of substitute products or services that could shrink the market.

4-The strength of each of these forces varies from industry to industry, but taken together they determine long-term profitability. They help to shape the prices companies can charge, the costs they must pay for resources and the level of investment that will be needed to compete.

5-From the external environment, he turns to the company itself. Companies make products and deliver them to consumers, but they can also add value to the basic product in a variety of ways and through different functions. Value can be added directly, for example by giving a product new technology features, or indirectly, through measures that allow the company to become more efficient. Prof Porter argues that every product follows a critical path through the company, from its inception to its delivery as a finished article. At every stage along this path there are opportunities to add value. This path he calls the 'value chain'

The value chain is crucial, he says, because it demonstrates that the company is more than just the sum of its parts and activities: all activities are connected, and what is done in one stage affects work at other stages. The company needs to examine its value chain and decide where it can add value most effectively to meet competitive pressures in the industry.

These concepts can be applied to entire sectors and national economies as well as individual companies, and Prof Porter went on to develop his theories of national competitiveness in great detail.

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PART 2 LANGUAGE

I/Choose the right alternative to complete these sentences:

1-I got into hot ..... with our boss for wearing casual clothes.

a-water **b-fire** **c-foot**

2-We ..... all the applicants yet.

a-have interviewed **b-haven't interviewed** **c-interviewed**

3-The company is planning to invest up to 40 billion dollars ..... the next two years in oil production.

a-over **b-on** **c-since**

4-Burners LTD has been officially ..... up for sale.

a-offered **b-set** **c-put**

5-Please .....; I don't want anyone else to hear us.

a-scream **b-blurt** **c-whisper**

6-What do we call a short profile of the job applicant at the beginning of a CV?

a-career summary **b-reference** **c-application form**

7-The new CEO transformed the bureaucratic ..... to profit-minded entrepreneurship.

a-corporate culture **b-common sense** **c-social responsibility**

8-He received a very generous ..... when he left the company.

a-fringe benefits **b-perks** **c-golden handshake**

9-The most ..... customers seem to be the worst tippers.

a-demand **b-demanding** **c-demanded**

10-When his boss told him he had to work at the weekend, he ..... something to himself and returned to his office.

a-muttered **b-nodded** **c-interrupted**

II-Express these sentences differently starting as given.

1- I did not come because you did not invite me.

-->If

.....

2-They did not make any reaction despite their anger.

-->Although

.....

3-You won't succeed unless you work harder.

-->Provided .....

4-She never arrives late to school .

-->Never .....

5-I regret not having taken a university degree.

-->I wish .....

III/Complete the sentences using the words between brackets in their correct form

1-(**mentor**) ..... a young executive requires a great deal of skill and in-depth knowledge.

2-The university (**lecture**) ..... was a man in his fifties who really enjoyed teaching young people about business management.

3-Human resources departments have difficulties (**assess**) ..... the true success of staff training and development programmes.

4-Could you give me a hand? I've got the (**instruct**) ..... leaflet, but I don't understand a thing.

5-The young (**train**) ..... were very keen on getting started in their new work placements.

IV/Circle the odd-one out in these lists:

*achieve - accomplish -fulfill -carry out - end up

*goals -targets - despair - aims - purposes

*precious - valuable - crucial - important - trivial

V/Join the two sentences together to make one:

A-She is the girl. Paul is going to marry.

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B-Gardening is a job. I have always wanted to try it.

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C-He is a musician. His album has sold millions.

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